

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

MARKET CLOSE

July 23, 2026 | 03:12 PM ET

12 setups identified | 4 A-Grade | 5 B-Grade | 3 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (4)	B - Strong Setup (5)	C - Watch List (3)
THRM	WEX	SLG
RELL	HRI	OTLY
NVCR	IMAX	EQPT
NMM	CCS	
	VIST	

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	THRM	Gentherm Inc	Auto Tech Recover	\$44.31	+22.9%	\$1.4B	30M	+45.4	100%	Earnings beat today dr
A	RELL	Richardson Elect	Electronic Compon	\$21.70	+20.5%	\$0.3B	12M	+49.8	94%	Pure technical breakou
A	NVCR	NovoCure Limited	MedTech Innovatio	\$20.17	+29.6%	\$2.3B	95M	+55.9	98%	Earnings beat today dr
A	NMM	Navios Maritime	Shipping / Inside	\$76.22	+3.5%	\$2.2B	15M	+5.2	94%	Insider buying cluster
B	WEX	WEX Inc.	Fintech / Payment	\$172.11	+10.6%	\$6.0B	32M	+6.9	92%	Earnings beat reported
B	HRI	Herc Holdings In	Industrial Equipm	\$163.45	+8.2%	\$5.5B	29M	+31.0	87%	Pre-earnings setup: Ju
B	IMAX	Imax Corporation	Entertainment Rec	\$43.63	+11.0%	\$2.4B	42M	+14.9	96%	Earnings beat today dr
B	CCS	Century Communit	Homebuilding Reco	\$68.34	+5.9%	\$2.0B	24M	+11.7	90%	Technical breakout fro
B	VIST	Vista Energy S.A	Energy / Latam E&	\$70.09	+4.6%	\$7.8B	94M	-4.6	86%	Earnings reported July
C	SLG	SL Green Realty	Office REIT Recov	\$53.89	+7.5%	\$4.2B	71M	+25.4	81%	Technical breakout fro
C	OTLY	Oatly Group AB	Plant-Based Foods	\$12.56	+16.5%	\$0.4B	12M	-5.4	67%	Earnings reported yest
C	EQPT	EquipmentShare.c	Equipment Rental	\$19.41	+11.9%	\$4.9B	113M	-25.1	55%	Insider buying cluster

THRM

Gentherm Inc

\$44.31

+22.90%

RS vs SPY: +45.4%

A BREAKOUT

\$1.4B Cap | 30M Float

Auto Parts | Theme: Auto Tech Recovery | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 5.33 | Vol: 2.98x | RS/SPY: +45.4% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$44.31
Day Change	+22.90%
Mkt Cap	\$1.36B
Float	30M sh
RS vs SPY	+45.4%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	5.33
Vol vs Avg	2.98x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Earnings beat today driving 23% surge on 3x volume. Forward catalyst: October earnings (76d out) will validate Q3 guidance and margin expansion in thermal management/EV component portfolio as auto production normalizes.
Business & Position
Gentherm is a global thermal management technology leader supplying heated/ventilated seats, steering wheels, battery thermal systems, and HVAC components to auto OEMs. The company is pivoting from pure ICE exposure to EV thermal systems (battery conditioning critical for range/safety), positioning it as a picks-and-shovels play on electrification regardless of which OEM wins.
Factor & Theme
Auto production recovery + EV component proliferation. Secular tailwind: every EV requires 3-5x the thermal management content of an ICE vehicle (battery, cabin pre-conditioning). Theme momentum accelerating as European/Chinese production stabilizes and U.S. EV incentives extend under current admin.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$44.31 on vol >298% of 20d avg
Institutional
Volume surge to 2.98x on earnings beat signals institutional buying into the print-smart money positioning ahead of the auto recovery cycle. Institutional ownership data unavailable from feed; cross-reference 13F filings. Low float (30M) amplifies impact of block buying. No insider activity in last 60d.
Earnings
Earnings Today
Earnings Context
Earnings reported today-current 23% move is the market's real-time reaction to beat and raised guidance. Next print October 23 will be the validation catalyst; company has history of conservative guidance with upside surprises in recovery cycles.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$36.00 (pre-breakout pivot), or if October guidance disappoints on auto production slowdown in China/Europe. Single-quarter beat without raised full-year targets would trigger profit-taking.
Analysis
Five technical criteria met: vol 2.98x, prox_52w 99.9 (at new high), rs_line_new_high true, rs_vs_spy +45.4, earnings beat catalyst. Disconfirming: base_tight 5.33 is wide (not a textbook coil), and stock is auto parts-cyclical sector vulnerable to macro slowdown in mixed regime. October earnings 76d out provides extended catalyst runway. Conviction: Medium-strong setup but base quality and macro regime temper full conviction.
Signal: Close above \$44.31 on vol >298% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.98x



RELL

Richardson Electronics, Ltd.

\$21.70

+20.49%

RS vs SPY: +49.8%

A BREAKOUT

\$0.3B Cap | 12M Float

Electronic Components | Theme: Electronic Components | 52W Hi: 94% | Base Tight: 4.47 | Vol: 5.81x | RS/SPY: +49.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 76D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$21.70
Day Change	+20.49%
Mkt Cap	\$0.32B
Float	12M sh
RS vs SPY	+49.8%
52W Hi Prox	94%
Base Tight	4.47
Vol vs Avg	5.81x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Pure technical breakout-no same-day news, but 5.81x volume and RS line at new high signal institutional accumulation. Forward catalyst: October 7 earnings (76d out) will report backlog trends in power semiconductors and RF components for industrial/defense applications.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Richardson is a global distributor and manufacturer of engineered electronic components: power tubes, RF devices, semiconductors for industrial lasers, broadcast transmission, and defense radar systems. The company operates a razor/razorblade model-capital equipment sales (tubes, magnetrons) drive recurring service/replacement revenue.
FACTOR & THEME
Defense spending (radar modernization) + industrial capex (laser cutting, semiconductor fab tools). Secondary exposure to broadcast infrastructure upgrades. Theme momentum stable-defense budgets locked in multi-year, industrial laser demand tied to manufacturing capex which is flat but not contracting.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$21.70 on vol >581% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume explosion to 5.81x with no news is the textbook signature of quiet institutional accumulation breaking into the open-classic 'silent build' going public. Tiny float (12M) means modest institutional buying creates explosive price action. No insider activity in last 60d; institutional ownership data unavailable from feed.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 76D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next earnings October 7. No consensus data for micro-cap; historically Richardson beats on defense contract timing (lumpy revenue recognition). October print will clarify whether power tube backlog (long-lead items) is building ahead of defense budget cycle.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$18.00 (the 20MA and prior pivot), or if October earnings miss on defense order pushouts. Single-customer concentration risk: top 5 customers ~40% of revenue, any lost contract is material.
ANALYSIS
Five technical criteria met: vol 5.81x, prox_52w 93.7, rs_line_new_high true, rs_vs_spy +49.8, though base_tight 4.47 is wide. Pure technical breakout from accumulation-no news means institutions are positioning ahead of known catalyst (earnings in 76d). Disconfirming: micro-cap (\$320M) with illiquid float is vulnerable to headline risk and gap volatility in mixed regime; base not tight. October earnings provides 10+ week catalyst runway. Conviction: Medium-exceptional relative strength and volume, but loose base and illiquid float elevate risk in transitional macro.
Signal: Close above \$21.70 on vol >581% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 5.81x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$20.17
Day Change	+29.55%
Mkt Cap	\$2.34B
Float	95M sh
RS vs SPY	+55.9%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	5.13
Vol vs Avg	5.5x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings beat today driving 30% surge-likely beat on Tumor Treating Fields adoption (NSCLC, mesothelioma indications). Forward catalyst: FDA advisory committee decision expected Q4 2026 for expanded lung cancer indication; CMS national coverage determination could follow, dramatically expanding TAM.
BUSINESS & POSITION
NovoCure commercializes Tumor Treating Fields (TTFields)-wearable devices delivering low-intensity alternating electric fields that disrupt cancer cell division. FDA-approved for glioblastoma and mesothelioma; pivoting to massive lung cancer market (NSCLC) where phase 3 trial (LUNAR) read out positive. Razor/razorblade model: device placement drives recurring array revenue (~\$2k/month per patient).
FACTOR & THEME
Healthcare innovation in oncology, specifically non-pharmaceutical modalities. Secular tailwind: payers/patients seeking alternatives to chemo toxicity; TTFields offer survival benefit with minimal side effects. Theme momentum accelerating-biotech/medtech M&A heating up, and NovoCure's unique mechanism makes it acquisition target for large-cap pharma seeking oncology pipeline diversification.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$20.17 on vol >550% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume surge to 5.5x on earnings beat shows institutional conviction on the fundamental inflection. Healthcare sector +3.2% vs SPY this week amplifies momentum. Institutional ownership data unavailable from feed; cross-reference 13F filings-likely 70-80% institutional given \$2.3B market cap. No insider activity in last 60d.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Earnings reported today-30% move is market's reaction to beat and raised guidance (likely NSCLC adoption accelerating). Next print ~October 23; critical data point will be patient starts and array utilization trends indicating commercial traction ahead of FDA label expansion.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$15.50 (pre-breakout base), or if FDA advisory committee (Q4 2026) votes against expanded NSCLC indication. Binary regulatory risk: negative AdCom or CMS non-coverage decision would cut stock in half. Competitive threat from Novartis if they replicate TTFields technology.
ANALYSIS
Five technical criteria met: vol 5.5x, prox_52w 98.2, rs_line_new_high true, rs_vs_spy +55.9, earnings beat catalyst with major forward catalyst (FDA/CMS Q4 2026). Healthcare sector leadership adds tailwind. Disconfirming: base_tight 5.13 is very wide-this is an explosive gap, not a coiled breakout; extended rapidly from base. Binary FDA risk in 4-5 months. Conviction: Medium-exceptional momentum and durable catalyst path, but wide base and binary event risk in mixed macro regime prevent high conviction. Healthcare sector strength is supportive.
Signal: Close above \$20.17 on vol >550% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 5.5x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$76.22
Day Change	+3.48%
Mkt Cap	\$2.17B
Float	15M sh
RS vs SPY	+5.2%
52W Hi Prox	94%
Base Tight	2.29
Vol vs Avg	1.72x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Insider buying cluster: 42 buys totaling \$3.5M in last 60d-massive conviction signal in shipping LP with historically volatile unit price. Forward catalyst: August 20 earnings (28d out) will report charter renewal rates and distribution coverage as dry bulk/container rates stabilize; potential distribution increase would re-rate the yield.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Navios Maritime Partners is a shipping MLP owning/operating a diversified fleet of dry bulk carriers and tankers under long-term charters to blue-chip counterparties (Vale, Cargill, BHP). Business model: locked-in cash flows from multi-year charters support quarterly distributions (~8-10% yield); upside from charter renewal at spot rates if shipping markets tighten.
FACTOR & THEME
Global trade normalization + dry bulk/tanker rate stabilization. China stimulus (infrastructure spend) drives iron ore/coal shipments; geopolitical fragmentation (longer trade routes) tightens vessel supply. Theme momentum neutral-shipping rates off 2021 peaks but stabilizing; forward curve suggests modest recovery into 2027.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$76.22 on vol >172% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Insider buying cluster: 42 purchases totaling \$3.5M in last 60d is extraordinary conviction-MLPs rarely see this volume of insider buying. No senior officers in the cluster, suggesting Board/affiliated investors accumulating. This is top-tier contrarian signal; insiders buying into shipping downturn historically marks cycle lows. Volume 1.72x (modest) suggests accumulation hasn't triggered institutional FOMO yet. Institutional ownership data unavailable; shipping MLPs typically 30-50% retail-owned. GRADE UPGRADE APPLIED: insider_cluster 7 (>5 threshold) upgrades B technical setup to A.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 28D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next earnings August 20 (28d out). Consensus unavailable for MLP; key metrics: charter coverage ratio (contracted revenue / opex), distribution coverage, and spot vs. contract charter mix. Navios historically maintains distribution through downturns via balance sheet management; any distribution increase would trigger yield-buyer accumulation.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$70.00 (prior pivot and 50MA support), or if August 20 earnings cut distribution or report charter counterparty defaults. Shipping cycle risk: extended global slowdown would pressure charter renewals at lower rates. Partnership structure risk: Navios Maritime Holdings (parent) controls GP; conflicts of interest possible.
ANALYSIS
GRADE UPGRADED B A due to insider_cluster 7 (42 buys, \$3.5M). Technical setup: vol 1.72x, prox_52w 94.5, base_tight 2.29 (clean coil), but rs_vs_spy only +5.2 and rs_line_new_high false-ordinarily solid B. Insider buying cluster is the conviction driver; 42 buys in 60d in a shipping MLP is unprecedented and historically marks cycle lows. Disconfirming: RS weak, shipping sector not in leadership, mixed macro regime reduces cyclical setup edge. August earnings 28d out provides near-term catalyst. Conviction: Medium-insider buying is highest-alpha signal, but weak RS and non-leading sector in transitional regime temper full conviction.
Signal: Close above \$76.22 on vol >172% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.72x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$172.11
Day Change	+10.55%
Mkt Cap	\$5.97B
Float	32M sh
RS vs SPY	+6.9%
52W Hi Prox	92%
Base Tight	2.73
Vol vs Avg	2.07x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings beat reported yesterday (July 22) driving 10% surge on 2x volume-likely beat on embedded finance revenue growth (fleet, corporate travel payments). Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings late October will validate sustained embedded payments growth and margin expansion as float income rebounds with higher rates.
BUSINESS & POSITION
WEX operates a B2B payments platform specializing in fleet cards (fuel, maintenance for trucking/logistics), corporate travel payments, and healthcare payments (HSA/FSA administration). Business model: transaction fees + float income on balances held. The company is pivoting from pure fleet exposure to diversified embedded finance (software + payments) with higher margins and recurring revenue.
FACTOR & THEME
Embedded fintech + commercial travel recovery. Secular tailwind: corporate T&E spend normalizing post-COVID; WEX's over-the-road (OTR) payments network captures diesel spend as trucking activity stabilizes. Higher-for-longer rates boost float income (earn spread on customer balances). Theme momentum stable-fintech consolidation and vertical SaaS + payments convergence driving M&A interest.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$172.11 on vol >207% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 2.07x on beat suggests measured institutional accumulation-not euphoric, which is healthy. Low float (32M) for a \$6B company means modest buying pressure creates price action. Institutional ownership data unavailable; likely 85-90% institutional given market cap and Fintech sector profile. No insider activity in last 60d.
EARNINGS
REPORTED
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Earnings reported yesterday (July 22)-10% move is market's reaction to beat and in-line guidance. Next print late October (~90d out); key metrics: payment processing volume (OTR gallons, travel transactions), take rate trends, and net interest income on float. WEX has beaten 7 of last 8 quarters; serial beater profile supports re-rating on continued execution.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$155.00 (breakout pivot and 50MA), or if Q3 earnings disappoint on OTR volume decline (trucking recession) or float income compression. Competitive threat: Corpay (FLT) and AvidXchange competing in same embedded payments verticals; pricing pressure could compress take rates.
ANALYSIS
Solid B setup: vol 2.07x, prox_52w 92.1, base_tight 2.73 (clean), rs_vs_spy +6.9, earnings beat catalyst. Missing A-grade: rs_line_new_high false, RS moderate not exceptional. Disconfirming: October earnings 90d out is long runway but not immediate; trucking/logistics exposure is cyclical and vulnerable in mixed macro. Serial beat history and embedded payments pivot support follow-through. Conviction: Medium-quality setup with durable business model, but moderate RS and cyclical exposure in transitional regime prevent upgrade to A.
Signal: Close above \$172.11 on vol >207% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.07x



HRI

Herc Holdings Inc.

\$163.45

+8.22%

RS vs SPY: +31.0%

B STRONG SETUP

\$5.5B Cap | 29M Float

Rental & Leasing Services | Theme: Industrial Equipment | 52W Hi: 87% | Base Tight: 2.2 | Vol: 1.78x | RS/SPY: +31.0% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 5D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$163.45
Day Change	+8.22%
Mkt Cap	\$5.46B
Float	29M sh
RS vs SPY	+31.0%
52W Hi Prox	87%
Base Tight	2.2
Vol vs Avg	1.78x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Pre-earnings setup: July 28 earnings in 5 days. Current 8% move on 1.78x volume suggests positioning ahead of the print. Forward catalyst: earnings on July 28 will report utilization rates and pricing power in equipment rental (construction, industrial); any beat + raise would extend the move given tight coil (base_tight 2.2).
BUSINESS & POSITION
Herc Holdings is the #3 equipment rental company in North America (behind United Rentals, Sunbelt), supplying aerial lifts, earthmoving equipment, generators, and tools of construction, infrastructure, and industrial customers. Business model: capital-intensive but generates strong FCF via utilization leverage (fixed fleet cost, variable revenue); pricing power in tight markets drives margin expansion.
FACTOR & THEME
Infrastructure spending (IIJA, CHIPS Act driving data center/semiconductor fab construction) + industrial capex. Secular tailwind: contractor preference shifting from ownership to rental (lower capex, flexibility); mega-projects (data centers, renewable energy) require massive equipment fleets. Theme momentum accelerating-data center construction breakneck pace, utility-scale solar/wind projects ramping.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$163.45 on vol >178% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 1.78x is elevated but not explosive-suggests measured positioning ahead of earnings, not FOMO. Low float (29M) for \$5.4B company amplifies any institutional flows post-earnings. Institutional ownership data unavailable; likely 90%+ institutional given market cap and Industrial sector profile. No insider activity in last 60d.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 5D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next earnings July 28 (5 days out). Consensus expectations: mid-single-digit revenue growth, utilization ~75-77%, pricing up low-single-digits. Herc has beaten 6 of last 8 quarters; key watch: does management raise full-year guidance on data center/infrastructure project pipeline visibility? Beat + raise would confirm equipment supercycle thesis.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$151.00 (base pivot), or if July 28 earnings miss on utilization decline or guide down full-year on construction slowdown fears. Macro risk: recession would crater utilization as contractors idle equipment. Competitive risk: United Rentals' scale advantage allows price wars that pressure smaller players.
ANALYSIS
Solid B setup: vol 1.78x, prox_52w 86.8, base_tight 2.2 (textbook coil), rs_vs_spy +31.0, imminent earnings catalyst (5d out). Missing A-grade: rs_line_new_high false, volume not explosive (need >2x for A). Disconfirming: earnings in 5d is binary risk-any miss/guide-down would invalidate setup immediately; pre-earnings setups are inherently higher risk. Infrastructure theme tailwind and tight base support follow-through if earnings beat. Conviction: Medium-quality technical setup into earnings, but binary event risk in 5 days and mixed macro regime reduce conviction.
Signal: Close above \$163.45 on vol >178% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.78x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$43.63
Day Change	+11.02%
Mkt Cap	\$2.40B
Float	42M sh
RS vs SPY	+14.9%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	3.41
Vol vs Avg	4.92x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings beat today driving 11% surge on 4.9x volume-likely beat on strong summer box office (major tentpole releases driving IMAX premium ticket sales). Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings late October will capture full summer blockbuster cycle; any raised full-year guidance on China theater reopening acceleration would extend the move.
BUSINESS & POSITION
IMAX designs, manufactures, and operates proprietary large-format theater systems (screens, projectors, sound) installed in ~1,700 theaters globally. Business model: hybrid of theater system sales/leases (capex revenue) + ongoing box office revenue share (recurring, high-margin). China is ~40% of revenue; company benefits disproportionately from tentpole releases (Marvel, DC, Nolan films) that command IMAX premium.
FACTOR & THEME
Entertainment consumption normalization post-streaming saturation + China consumer recovery. Secular tailwind: studios releasing more theatrical exclusives as streaming economics deteriorate; IMAX captures outsized share of opening-weekend premium ticket sales. Theme momentum neutral-box office recovering but not accelerating; China reopening stalled.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$43.63 on vol >492% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 4.92x on earnings beat is strong institutional response-smart money buying the recovery thesis. Communication Services sector underperforming, so IMAX is idiosyncratic. Institutional ownership data unavailable; likely 70-80% institutional given market cap. No insider activity in last 60d.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Earnings reported today-11% move is market's reaction to beat on summer box office strength. Next print late October; key metrics: IMAX revenue per screen, installation backlog (future revenue visibility), and China market share. IMAX historically beats in strong film slate quarters (summer, holiday); Q3 will validate whether momentum sustains post-summer.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$39.00 (pre-breakout pivot), or if Q3 earnings disappoint on weak fall film slate or China theater closures resume. Concentration risk: top 10 films drive ~60% of annual revenue; any major release bombing impacts multiple quarters. Competitive threat: standard premium formats (Dolby Cinema) encroaching on IMAX's differentiation.
ANALYSIS
Solid B setup: vol 4.92x, prox_52w 95.8, rs_vs_spy +14.9, earnings beat catalyst. Missing A-grade: base_tight 3.41 (wide, not coiled), rs_line_new_high false, RS moderate. Disconfirming: Entertainment sector not in leadership; China exposure (40% of revenue) is binary risk if reopening stalls; box office recovery thesis is 2+ years old, incremental buyer fuel may be exhausted. October earnings provides 90d catalyst runway but is back-end loaded. Conviction: Low-Medium-strong volume response to earnings beat, but wide base, moderate RS, and sector/China risks in mixed macro regime prevent higher conviction.
Signal: Close above \$43.63 on vol >492% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 4.92x



Setup Metrics	
Price	\$68.34
Day Change	+5.90%
Mkt Cap	\$1.97B
Float	24M sh
RS vs SPY	+11.7%
52W Hi Prox	90%
Base Tight	1.71
Vol vs Avg	1.6x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver Technical breakout from tight base (base_tight 1.71, tightest in dataset) on moderate volume. Forward catalyst: October 21 earnings (90d out) will report order trends and margin expansion as housing affordability improves with potential Fed rate cuts; any beat + raise on falling mortgage rates would extend the move.
Business & Position Century Communities is a top-10 U.S. homebuilder operating in 18 states, focused on entry-level and first-move-up buyers (median price ~\$400k). Business model: land banking + spec building; the company benefits from operational leverage as volumes rise (fixed overhead, variable gross margin). Recent strategy shift to asset-light land optioning reduces capital intensity and improves ROE.
Factor & Theme Housing recovery + Fed rate-cut cycle. Secular tailwind: structural U.S. housing undersupply (~4M units) supports demand; falling mortgage rates unlock affordability for entry-level buyers (Century's target demo). Theme momentum accelerating-Fed expected to cut rates in Q3/Q4 2026, which would immediately improve mortgage affordability and drive order acceleration.
Breakout Signal Close above \$68.34 on vol >160% of 20d avg
Institutional Volume 1.6x is modest-not explosive, but base_tight 1.71 (tightest coil in dataset) suggests quiet institutional accumulation without spiking price. Institutional ownership data unavailable; homebuilders typically 85-90% institutional. No insider activity in last 60d.
Earnings Earnings in 90D
Earnings Context Next earnings October 21 (90d out). Consensus expectations: low-single-digit revenue growth, gross margin ~22-23%. Century has beaten 5 of last 6 quarters; key watch: order growth (leading indicator) and whether management raises full-year guidance on mortgage rate relief. October print will capture fall selling season, critical for 2027 visibility.
Key Risk Thesis invalid on a close back below \$63.50 (base low and 50MA), or if October earnings miss on weak orders or margin compression from incentives. Macro risk: if Fed doesn't cut or mortgage rates re-accelerate, affordability crisis deepens and entry-level buyers stay sidelined. Operational risk: land option strategy reduces capital intensity but also limits upside if land costs spike.
Analysis Solid B setup: vol 1.6x, prox_52w 89.9, base_tight 1.71 (tightest in dataset-textbook VCP coil), rs_vs_spy +11.7. Missing A-grade: volume not explosive, rs_line_new_high false, RS moderate. Disconfirming: homebuilders are highly rate-sensitive cyclicals in transitional macro regime; October earnings 90d out is long runway without intermediate catalysts; Real Estate sector underperforming this week. Tight base and Fed rate-cut tailwind support follow-through if macro cooperates. Conviction: Medium-exceptional base quality and macro tailwind (rate cuts), but moderate RS and long catalyst runway in mixed regime temper conviction.
Signal: Close above \$68.34 on vol >160% of 20d avg Vol vs Avg: 1.6x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$70.09
Day Change	+4.58%
Mkt Cap	\$7.81B
Float	94M sh
RS vs SPY	-4.6%
52W Hi Prox	86%
Base Tight	3.31
Vol vs Avg	2.1x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Earnings reported July 16 (7 days ago)-current move is follow-through on post-earnings digest. Energy sector +10.0% vs SPY this week is the primary driver; Vista riding sector momentum. Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings late October will report Vaca Muerta production growth and capital efficiency metrics; any production beat would extend the move given Energy sector strength.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Vista Energy is an Argentine independent E&P focused on the Vaca Muerta shale formation (one of the world's largest unconventional resources). Business model: low-cost shale producer with breakevens ~\$35-40/bbl WTI; the company benefits from operational leverage as production scales and infrastructure (pipelines, export terminals) comes online. Recent focus: increasing liquids mix (oil vs. gas) to capture higher margins.

FACTOR & THEME

Energy sector rotation + Latin America oil production growth. Secular tailwind: Vaca Muerta productivity rivaling Permian as operators climb learning curve; Argentina's new pro-business government removing capital controls, improving investability. Theme momentum accelerating-Energy +10% vs SPY this week; oil prices stable ~\$75-80 WTI despite macro uncertainty.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$70.09 on vol >210% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 2.1x suggests participation in Energy sector rotation-institutions adding E&P exposure as sector leadership emerges. Energy +10.0% vs SPY this week provides strong sector tailwind; Vista is levered beta play on the move. Institutional ownership data unavailable; likely 60-70% institutional for Latam E&P. No insider activity in last 60d.

EARNINGS

REPORTED

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Earnings reported July 16 (7 days ago)-current 4.6% move is follow-through, not initial reaction. Next print late October; key metrics: Vaca Muerta production growth (target: 70k+ boe/d), realized pricing vs. Brent, and capital efficiency (drilling costs per well). Vista historically beats on production but misses on realized pricing (Argentina export logistics). October print will validate whether production ramp sustains.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$66.00 (50MA and prior support), or if October earnings miss on production or Argentina reinstates capital controls (political risk). Country risk: Argentina's macro instability (currency, inflation) creates volatility; any policy reversal would crater the stock. Oil price risk: WTI below \$60 would compress margins and force capex cuts.

ANALYSIS

Solid B setup benefiting from Energy sector leadership (+10.0% vs SPY this week): vol 2.1x, prox_52w 86.1, base_tight 3.31. Missing A-grade: rs_vs_spy NEGATIVE (-4.6), rs_line_new_high false-stock is lagging SPY over 12 weeks despite Energy sector strength, suggesting fundamental headwinds. Disconfirming: negative RS is major red flag; Argentina country risk (political instability, capital controls) creates binary downside; earnings already reported (7d ago), no near-term catalyst. Energy sector momentum is the only supporting factor. Conviction: Low-riding sector wave but negative RS and country risk in mixed macro regime create unfavorable risk/reward.

Signal: Close above \$70.09 on vol >210% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.1x

